

Veterans Backbone Complaints & Feedback Framework

Why This Exists

Nobody gets everything right all the time.

Veterans Backbone welcomes complaints, feedback, suggestions, compliments, and constructive criticism because improvement only happens when people are willing to listen.

This framework exists to ensure concerns are heard, reviewed fairly, and responded to openly.

Our Principles

We Listen

People deserve to be heard without being dismissed, ignored, or made to feel like a problem.

We Stay Professional

Feedback may sometimes be emotional, frustrated, or uncomfortable.

We focus on understanding the issue rather than reacting to the emotion behind it.

We Learn

Where mistakes are identified, we use them as opportunities to improve systems, services, and practice.

We Remain Transparent

Where possible, people will be told what has been reviewed, what was found, and what actions will follow.

We Do Not Retaliate

Nobody should be disadvantaged for raising a genuine complaint or providing honest feedback.

What Can Be Raised

People may provide:

- Complaints
- Suggestions
- Feedback
- Compliments
- Service improvement ideas
- Concerns about processes

- Concerns about decisions

What This Framework Is Not

This framework is not intended for:

- Safeguarding concerns
- Immediate safety risks
- Criminal matters
- Whistleblowing concerns
- Serious misconduct concerns

These are managed through the Raising Concerns Framework.

Outcomes

Feedback may result in:

- Clarification
- Apology
- Learning actions
- Process changes
- Staff guidance
- Further investigation

Not every complaint will result in the outcome requested, but every genuine complaint will be considered fairly.

Why It Matters

Trust is built when organisations are willing to hear uncomfortable truths.

Veterans Backbone would rather hear difficult feedback than create a culture where people stay silent.